Using the Tools Panel

The Tools panel contains a collection of tools. When you move the mouse pointer on a tool, its name appears.

Some tools in the Tools panel have additional options that allow you to modify their use. For example, the Brush tool has options for changing the size and shape of the brush head. When the tool is selected, the options are available in the Options area of the Tools panel.

Selection Tool (V)

This tool is used to select an object or parts of an object, such as the stroke or fill, and to reshape and reposition objects. The options for the Selection tool are Snap to Objects (aligns objects), Smooth (smooths lines), and Straighten (straightens lines).

Subselection Tool (A)

This tool is used to select, drag, and reshape an object. We know that vector graphics are composed of lines and curves (each of which is a segment) connected by anchor points. When you select an object with this tool, it displays the anchor points and allows you to use them to edit the object.

Free Transform Tool (Q)

It is used to rotate, scale, skew, and distort objects.

Gradient Transform Tool (F)

It is used to transform a gradient fill by adjusting the size, direction, or center of the fill. The Free and Gradient Transform tools are grouped within one icon on the Tools panel. To see the menu containing grouped tools, click and hold the tool icon until the menu opens.

3D Rotation Tool (W)

It is used to create 3D effects by rotating movie clips in 3D space on the Stage.

3D Translation Tool (G)

It is used to create 3D effects by moving movie clips in 3D space on the Stage. The 3D Rotation and the 3D Translation tools are grouped within one icon on the Tools panel.

Lasso Tool (L)

It is used to select objects or parts of objects by drawing a freehand.

Pen Tool (P)

It is used to draw lines and curves by creating a series of dots, known as anchor points, that are automatically connected. Other tools used to add, delete, and convert the anchor points created by the Pen tool are grouped with the Pen tool.

Text Tool (T)

It is used to create and edit text.

Line Tool (N)

It is used to draw straight lines. You can draw vertical, horizontal, and 45° diagonal lines by pressing and holding Shift key while drawing the line.

Rectangle Tool(R)

It is used to draw rectangular shapes. Press and hold **Shift** key to draw a perfect square.

Oval Tool (O)

It is used to draw oval shapes. Press and hold **Shift** key to draw a perfect circle.

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